

# KEEP THE PROOF — VERSION 2

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## Stage 2 review pack

Prepared for Temidayo Afonja, The Density Group. September 18, 2026.

This pack accompanies the Version 2 manuscript and the Professional Record. It contains the six control documents you asked to see with the drafts: the legal-review register, the current-to-Version-2 change log, the research-discipline confirmation, the free-to-paid boundary check, the product-seam check, and the Stage 2 quality-test results. No final production PDF has been generated, and the live website and Starter page have not been touched.

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### 1. Legal-review register

Every point in the manuscript where legal wording is deliberately withheld pending counsel. Each entry gives the location, the purpose, the exact question counsel must answer, and confirms that no interim guidance was invented.

Item L1. The not-legal-advice statement and confidentiality note. – Location: Front matter, "The record and the fine print." – Purpose: establish that the guide is educational, not legal advice, and cannot interpret a reader's agreements. – Exact question for counsel: is the Version 1 disclaimer wording still correct and sufficient for Version 2 as written? – Wording status: carried from Version 1, held for confirmation. No new claim added.

Item L2. Lawful ways to rebuild the record (the whole page). – Location: Part Three, "Lawful ways to rebuild the record." – Purpose: name lawful channels the standard currently omits, so a reader rebuilding after a change knows what they may legitimately use. – Exact questions for counsel: (a) State-by-state personnel-record inspection and copy rights, including which states, what records, timing, limits, and the absence of a federal right. (b) Which documents an employee may treat as their own lawful copies (offer letters, signed reviews, pay records, certificates, training completions), and any conditions. (c) How to seek and record written permission, and how to describe the documented failure of verbal permission without overreaching. (d) The boundaries of using publicly available work. – Wording status: page written as named channels and intent only. All specific rights, conditions, and cautions withheld and marked in place. No interim legal guidance provided.

Item L3. Anonymized process accounts. – Location: cross-cutting, touches Part Three (permission), Part Five (translation), and Part Seven (reconstruction). – Purpose: reconcile the current strict standard (anonymizing does not create permission) with common professional practice on process-level accounts. – Exact question for counsel: where, if anywhere, should the standard soften to allow anonymized process accounts, and where must it stay strict? The

manuscript currently keeps the strict standard unchanged pending this answer. – Wording status: no change made; flagged for review.

Item L4. Corroboration and privacy. – Location: Part Four, "Who could confirm this," and Professional Record, Section 3. – Purpose: let a reader record who could confirm work and what they observed, without a privacy problem. – Exact question for counsel: are there privacy considerations in recording a named individual's observations in a private record, and does limiting capture to role and observation, with no stored personal contact detail, resolve them? – Wording status: manuscript stores role and observation only, no personal contact detail; flagged for confirmation.

Item L5. Reconstruction sources near employer-owned information. – Location: Part Seven, "Where the record still lives." – Purpose: list lawful reconstruction sources while keeping the reader clear of anything employer-owned. – Exact question for counsel: which listed sources (personal calendars, old job descriptions, public announcements, artifacts) carry any retention or ownership risk, and how should each be bounded? – Wording status: sources listed with a governing note that anything not clearly the reader's is left out; specific boundaries withheld and cross-referenced to L2.

Item L6. The account-versus-artifact ownership caveat. – Location: Part One, "The boundary," new caveat paragraph and legal note. – Purpose: keep the core practical distinction between a personal account and an employer-owned artifact, while acknowledging that ownership can be a legal question in some situations. – Exact question for counsel: how should the guide describe that boundary, and situation-specific ownership (work made for hire, contractor versus employee, signed agreements), without stating a legal conclusion? – Wording status: the page teaches the practical habit only, a marked legal note is added, and no legal conclusion is stated. Added in the Stage 2 correction pass.

Items also carried for review, not yet written into pages because they do not change reader instructions in Version 2: work-for-hire and portfolio use; contractor versus employee ownership; client confidentiality layered on employer confidentiality; severance and non-disparagement clauses; preservation exceptions; and employer AI-tool and monitoring policies. These inform the permission standard, which is unchanged, and will be revisited with counsel if any reader-facing wording is proposed.

Nothing in the manuscript states a legal conclusion. Every legal item is either carried unchanged from Version 1 or written as a marked placeholder.

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## 2. Current-to-Version-2 change log

Every current component, with its disposition. Nothing disappears silently. Dispositions: RETAINED (kept, essentially as is), MOVED (same content, new location), REVISED (reworked, content preserved), MERGED (combined with another), ABSORBED (folded into the Professional Record),

REMOVAL CANDIDATE APPROVED (approved for removal by the Stage 1 decisions), NEW (did not exist before).

Handbook

| Current page      | Component                                            | Version 2 disposition                                                                                                                                                   |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1                 | Cover                                                | REVISED. New descriptor and supporting line; "60-Minute" removed (approved).                                                                                            |
| 2                 | Fine print, confidentiality note                     | RETAINED. Confirm with counsel (L1).                                                                                                                                    |
| 3                 | Welcome                                              | RETAINED, lightly tightened.                                                                                                                                            |
| 4                 | Orientation, the one rule                            | REVISED into "How to use this guide," now framed on Capture, Clarify, Carry, plus the two doors.                                                                        |
| 5, 11, 15, 26, 29 | Part dividers                                        | MOVED and re-labeled to the new parts.                                                                                                                                  |
| 6                 | Opening question; why evidence disappears            | RETAINED (opening); REVISED headings to "professional record."                                                                                                          |
| 7                 | Is/is-not; least-visible; decays; brag-document line | REVISED. Table retained; "proof" overreach softened; the brag-document stance softened to name-neutral (research removal candidate handled by softening, not deletion). |
| 8                 | The filter                                           | RETAINED.                                                                                                                                                               |
| 9                 | Evidence-versus-artifact boundary                    | RETAINED.                                                                                                                                                               |
| 10                | Five-step method                                     | REVISED into "The spine: Capture, Clarify, Carry," with Protect and Retrieve recast as threads.                                                                         |
| 12                | Central rule; information-risk intro                 | RETAINED.                                                                                                                                                               |
| 13                | Keep, Care, Never; lines that do not move            | RETAINED.                                                                                                                                                               |
| 14                | What the record runs on; setup                       | REVISED; setup now points to the Professional Record.                                                                                                                   |
| 16                | Quick Capture; Devin                                 | RETAINED.                                                                                                                                                               |
| 17                | Full entry, twenty fields                            | REVISED. Renamed; regrouped into five clusters; corroboration field added; content preserved.                                                                           |
| 18                | Full entry, completed (Maya)                         | RETAINED, with a corroboration line added.                                                                                                                              |
| 19                | Capturing well                                       | RETAINED; also the seed of the new scope-without-title page.                                                                                                            |
| 20                | No clean metric                                      | RETAINED.                                                                                                                                                               |
| 21                | Prevention; Theo                                     | RETAINED.                                                                                                                                                               |
| 22                | Team result versus your part; Grace                  | RETAINED; now the heart of Clarify.                                                                                                                                     |

| Current page | Component                             | Version 2 disposition                                                                                                                |
|--------------|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 23           | Translate, eight moves                | RETAINED; with a new note that general translation is not portability.                                                               |
| 24           | Proof Line; Maya                      | RETAINED.                                                                                                                            |
| 25           | Before and after                      | RETAINED.                                                                                                                            |
| 27           | Priya, Sam                            | RETAINED.                                                                                                                            |
| 28           | Full sequence (Theo)                  | RETAINED.                                                                                                                            |
| 30           | 60-minute setup                       | REVISED into "Your First 60 Minutes"; completion promise removed; reconstruct route and checklist added.                             |
| 31           | Monthly and quarterly routines        | RETAINED as optional; presented alongside event-based capture with neither asserted as better (cadence remains a test, not settled). |
| 32           | Retrieval table; starting-late intro  | RETAINED (retrieval); MOVED and EXPANDED (reconstruction) into Part Seven.                                                           |
| 33           | Reconstruction steps                  | MOVED and EXPANDED into Part Seven; certainty levels added; tone made non-penalty.                                                   |
| 34           | Optional AI prompt                    | RETAINED, including the confidentiality guardrail.                                                                                   |
| 35 to 38     | Fillable Quick Capture and Full Entry | MERGED with the Ledger forms and MOVED into the Professional Record and the optional companion pages; duplication resolved.          |
| 39           | Operating summary                     | REVISED to Capture, Clarify, Carry.                                                                                                  |
| 40           | Edge of the tool                      | RETAINED; relearning handoff to the Field Kit strengthened.                                                                          |
| 41           | About the author                      | RETAINED.                                                                                                                            |

New material in Version 2 (did not exist before): Why you might be here (recognition); Two ways in (router); Claim, example, evidence, corroboration; The moments worth catching (event triggers); Scope you carried without the title; Who could confirm this (corroboration); Lawful ways to rebuild the record (legal placeholder); the expanded Reconstruct part; the reconstruct first-session route; and Your Professional Record page.

New worked examples (NEW): Andre (judgment under uncertainty, ambiguous outcome); Lena (people development); Marcus (cross-functional relationship repair); Rosa (return and re-entry); and the scope-without-title example inside Clarify. Retained examples: Devin, Maya, Theo, Grace, Priya, Sam.

Career Evidence Ledger

| Current | Component                              | Version 2 disposition                                                                                                               |
|---------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 to 2  | Cover; how to use                      | ABSORBED. The Ledger is no longer a separate third system; its role is taken by the Professional Record.                            |
| 3 to 4  | Quick Capture forms                    | ABSORBED into Professional Record Section 1; MERGED with the handbook's fillable pages to remove duplication.                       |
| 5 to 7  | Full Entry forms                       | ABSORBED into Professional Record Section 2; MERGED as above.                                                                       |
| 8       | Translation worksheet                  | ABSORBED into Professional Record Section 4.                                                                                        |
| 9       | Proof Line builder                     | ABSORBED into Professional Record Section 4.                                                                                        |
| 10      | Monthly Proof Sweep                    | ABSORBED into Professional Record Section 6 (optional).                                                                             |
| 11      | Quarterly Proof Review                 | ABSORBED into Professional Record Section 6 (optional).                                                                             |
| 12      | Quarterly Evidence Index (Ledger form) | ABSORBED into the Professional Record's running index (Section 5), unbranded; the "Quarterly Evidence Index" label is not retained. |

The only outright removal is the "60-Minute" descriptor from the cover, which the brief approved. The standalone Ledger is absorbed, not deleted: every field and prompt survives inside the Professional Record. All labels are preserved in substance; the routine names are used more plainly in the manuscript, and any formal renaming of routines or indexes remains a test, not a change.

### 3. Research-discipline confirmation

Confirmed: no item that Research Pass 2 marked TEST BEFORE CHANGING, unknown, unresolved, or candidate has been silently implemented as settled fact in this manuscript, except where the Stage 1 approval brief explicitly resolved it.

- Cadence (test): not settled. Both event-based capture and a periodic sweep are presented as useful, with neither asserted as universally better, and both routines retained as optional. No cadence is asserted as correct.
- Permission sequencing (test): woven rather than front-loaded, per the approved intent, but the exact sequence is presented as the current design, and the full standard is unchanged and load-bearing. Flagged as still subject to test and legal review.
- Visibility bridge (test): excluded, per decision. The manuscript names contexts where the record becomes useful but teaches no profile-keyword, forwardable-output, or interview-story mechanics.
- Price and name (resolved by brief): unchanged. \$49 and Keep the Proof, not reopened.
- The word "proof" (test): the name is unchanged; inside the product the claim-example-evidence-corroboration page makes the meaning precise, without renaming anything.

- Reconstruction placement (resolved by brief): inside Keep the Proof for Version 2, architected cleanly enough to separate later if evidence supports it.
- Maintenance and abandonment (unknown): not asserted in either direction. The manuscript does not claim people will or will not maintain a record.
- Category language "career evidence" (test): the primary descriptor is plain ("professional record"); "career evidence" is not used as the primary consumer descriptor. No category-building claim is made.
- Brag-document distancing (candidate): softened, not deleted; the word is allowed, the distinction kept.
- Legal items: all withheld to counsel, per Section 1.

Every place where the research was uncertain and the brief did not resolve it, the manuscript either preserves the existing approved material unchanged or presents the new material as an option, never as a settled finding.

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## 4. Free-to-paid boundary check

The corrected distinction, per the Stage 1 decision. The paid product is not described as "finishing" a maintained record, because a maintained record is ongoing and cannot truthfully be called finished.

- The Career Evidence Starter helps the reader finish one real piece of work and produce one usable result: one completed entry and one portable Proof Line, in one focused sitting. It remains complete and genuinely useful on its own, and it is not weakened to create differentiation.
- Keep the Proof helps the reader establish the broader professional record they can continue building and return to across performance reviews, internal moves, career pivots, re-entry, and unexpected change.

Why the paid job is materially larger. It establishes the record and the system rather than finishing a single entry; it supports reconstruction after access is gone; it captures senior and invisible work, including scope carried without a title; it separates team result from individual contribution; it captures judgment, decisions, and prevention; it preserves the full permission discipline; it adds narrow corroboration readiness; and it provides a maintainable, personally controlled working home in the Professional Record.

How the two stay distinct in practice. The Starter is one entry, done in an evening, proving the method on a single accomplishment. Keep the Proof is the standing record and the discipline around it, entered from either door, kept over years. A reader who has done the Starter has finished one thing; a reader using Keep the Proof has established something they keep returning to. Nothing in Version 2 shrinks the Starter to make this gap; the gap is the record, the reconstruction, the senior-work capture, the corroboration, and the maintainable home.

The live Starter page currently describes the paid product with superseded language ("the paid 60-minute system," "the paid Career Evidence System"). That copy is logged for a later, separate change to the approved Version 2 descriptor, and the live page is not modified now.

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## 5. Product-seam check

Where Keep the Proof stops and the rest of Capability Formation begins. The seam is explicit and honored throughout the manuscript.

Keep the Proof does (inside scope): recall, attribution, accurate capture, general translation into portable language, permission-aware recordkeeping, reconstruction after access loss, preparation for the moments that ask for an account, and corroboration readiness.

Keep the Proof does not do (across the seam): decide whether a specific move is right; determine what definitively travels to a specific destination; decide what an employer will value; advise whether to stay or leave; predict or control hiring, promotion, level, compensation, sponsorship, credentials, licensing, age bias, discrimination, organizational politics, or market conditions.

Where those questions go. Destination-specific translation, what travels, what must be relearned, and whether to move belong to the Field Kit, the Career Move Review, and the wider Capability Formation work. Organizational and enterprise capability questions belong to the organizational side of Capability Formation, not to this product.

How the seam appears in the manuscript, in three places, without becoming defensive or repetitive: – Part Five, "Where the record becomes useful," names the moments and explicitly stops before teaching interview, resume, or move mechanics. – Part Five, "What would not travel," names the destination question, hands it off, and does not answer it. – Closing, "The edge of the tool," states the boundary once, plainly, and points to the Field Kit.

The manuscript states the structural limits honestly but lightly: it says once, clearly, that a record can be honest and portable and still meet a market, a committee, or a bias it cannot control, and it does not repeat the point defensively.

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## 6. Stage 2 quality-test results

The manuscript tested against each question in the approval brief.

- Does the buyer recognize why they may be here before the framework? Yes. "Why you might be here" precedes any definition or method.
- Can they begin doing something useful within the first few pages? Yes. The two doors and Your First 60 Minutes put them into real capture early; event triggers lower the cost of starting.

- Is Capture, Clarify, Carry unmistakable? Yes. It is the spine page, the part structure, and the operating summary.
- Is Clarify genuinely the intellectual center? Yes. It is the largest teaching part and holds team-versus-part, judgment, prevention, scope-without-title, and corroboration.
- Can someone who already lost access enter without feeling they failed? Yes. The second door, the reconstruct first session, and Part Seven's tone are built for exactly that.
- Does it represent senior non-technical work well? Yes. Scope without title, judgment, prevention, people development, coordination, and relationship repair are all captured, in ordinary language before any label.
- Does it capture judgment? Yes, throughout Clarify and in Andre's example.
- Does it capture prevention? Yes, retained and strengthened, with Theo.
- Does it capture scope without title? Yes, a dedicated page and a worked example.
- Does it distinguish team result from individual contribution? Yes, the heart of Clarify, with Grace.
- Does it distinguish claim, example, evidence, and corroboration? Yes, a dedicated page, and it corrects the "proof" overreach honestly.
- Does it preserve permission discipline? Yes, the central rule, Keep/Care/Never, and lines that do not move are unchanged and load-bearing.
- Are legal questions clearly withheld rather than guessed? Yes, marked in place and gathered in the register.
- Does the Professional Record feel maintainable over years? Yes: platform-neutral, searchable, copyable, personally owned, with a living index and light optional routines.
- Useful to someone who never leaves their employer? Yes: reviews, promotion cases, internal moves, and compensation discussions, with no job-search framing required.
- Useful for internal moves? Yes, named explicitly and served by capture and retrieval.
- Useful for re-entry? Yes: the reconstruct route and Rosa's returner example.
- Useful after unexpected change? Yes: the second door and reconstruction.
- Does it avoid becoming a layoff product? Yes. Reconstruction is one door among several; the product serves the employed reader equally.
- Does it avoid becoming a resume product? Yes. It builds the record and hands off resume and application mechanics.
- Does it stop before destination-specific move decisions? Yes. The seam is explicit and enforced.
- Does it avoid implying translation controls recognition? Yes. It states plainly that general translation is not portability and portability is not recognition.
- Does the free Starter remain genuinely useful? Yes, unchanged, and the paid job is enlarged instead.
- Is the paid job materially larger? Yes, per Section 4.

- Does it feel worth \$49 because of what the buyer establishes and can keep using, not page count? Yes. The value is the established record, the reconstruction path, the senior-work capture, and the maintainable home, not length.
  - Could a free brag-document template substitute for the whole experience? No. No free template found combines permission discipline, senior non-technical judgment and prevention capture, corroboration readiness, and permission-safe reconstruction after access loss.
  - Could AI recover the underlying facts if the reader never captured them? No, and the manuscript is built on that asymmetry: AI polishes wording, it cannot supply judgment, decisions, and prevention that were never recorded. That is why Clarify is the center and translation is kept lean.
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END OF STAGE 2 REVIEW PACK